Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
**BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT**
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

**SECOND REGULAR SESSION**

**RESOLUTION NO. 399**

**RESOLUTION DIRECTING THE MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT, NATURAL RESOURCES AND ENERGY TO INTENSIFY ITS REFORESTATION PROGRAMS, ESPECIALLY IN THE LANDSLIDE-PRONE AREAS**

**WHEREAS,** Section 16, Article II of the 1987 Philippine Constitution states that the State shall protect and advance the right of the people to a balanced and healthy ecology in accord with the rhythm and harmony of nature;

**WHEREAS,** Section 8, Article XIII of Republic Act No. 11054 or the Bangsamoro Organic Law states that the protection, conservation, rehabilitation, and development of forests, coastal, and marine resources, including the adoption of programs and projects, to ensure the maintenance of ecological balance and biodiversity shall be given priority;

**WHEREAS,** Section 8 of Republic Act No. 10176 or the "*Arbor Day Act of 2012*" states that all able-bodied citizens of the Philippines, who are at least 12 years of age, shall be required to plant one (1) tree every year;

**WHEREAS,** the Bangsamoro Government released Executive Order No. 007 series of 2020 institutionalizing the Integrated Bangsamoro Greening Program (IBGP) in the entire Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM);

**WHEREAS,** the IBGP is a banner program of the Bangsamoro Government under the leadership of Chief Minister Ahod Balawag Ebrahim through the Ministry of Environment, Natural Resources and Energy (MENRE). IBGP aims to grow 171.2 million trees covering about 159,000 hectares of forestland within the Area of Responsibility of BARMM. It also promotes poverty reduction, resource protection and management, productivity enhancement, food security and nutrition normalization process, and climate change mitigation and adaptation;

**WHEREAS,** around 11.5 million tree seedlings have been planted on 10,401 hectares of land across BARMM according to MENRE;

**WHEREAS,** the reforestation activity is one of the environmental interventions to minimize the effects of natural calamities and reduce climate change according to the Director of Forest Management Services Forester Abdul-Jalil Umngan, he added that *"The impact of climate change knocks on our doors already and there is no quick solution to lessen the floods aside from reforestation. That is why, we encourage people to support environmental advocacies for the current and future generations;"*

**WHEREAS,** on October 27, 2022, Severe Tropical Storm *Paeng*, with the international name *Nalgae*, battered some parts of Maguindanao del Norte, Maguindanao del Sur, Cotabato City, and other parts of Southwestern Mindanao. Heavy rains brought by the Severe Tropical Storm *Paeng* caused landslides and severe flooding in the mentioned areas;

**WHEREAS,** as of October 31, 2022, the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council said deaths from Severe Tropical Storm *Paeng* have reached 110, with 101 injured and 33 missing, and 59 of the confirmed fatalities were from BARMM, which suffered massive floods and landslides;

**WHEREAS,** severe losses from *Paeng* in the autonomous region prompted President Ferdinand "Bongbong" Marcos, Jr. to call for the intensification of tree-planting efforts in BARMM as he expressed alarm over massive deforestation in Maguindanao province. He pointed out the need to plant trees to tackle flooding as he acknowledged threats of climate change. The President noticed that areas badly hit by *Paeng* were the ones that had been deforested:

**NOW, THEREFORE,** be it

**RESOLVED,** as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, To direct the Ministry of Environment, Natural Resources and Energy to intensify its reforestation programs, especially in the landslide-prone areas.

**RESOLVED, FURTHER,** To forward this Resolution to the MENRE, for information.

**RESOLVED, FINALLY,** To direct MENRE to submit a list of landslide and flood-prone areas in the BARMM and facilitate the publication of the same.

**ADOPTED,** *Rabi Al-Awwal* 04, 1445/September 19, 2023.

Certified Correct:

**PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL**
Secretary-General

Attested:

**ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG**
Speaker

**xxx**